

Unfinished business: Joshua Van (facing page, left) wrestles Alexandre Pantoja in the UFC flyweight championship fight during the UFC 323 event at T-Mobile Arena in 2025 in Las Vegas, Nevada. PICS: GETTY IMAGES

the Octagon.

Now, they get the chance to settle the question properly.

Van will defend his title against former champion Pantoja in the main event of UFC 331 in Los Angeles on September 20.

Since his win over Pantoja, the 24-year-old has strengthened his claim to being the division's legitimate champion.

He successfully defended the title against Tatsuro Taira at UFC 328 in May, winning by fifth-round TKO. Van enters the rematch with a 17-2 record and nine knockout victories.

Pantoja, meanwhile, is looking to reclaim the title he successfully defended four times against Brandon Royval, Steve Erceg, Kai Asakura, and Kai Kara-France.

At 36, the Brazilian is attempting to become only the third flyweight in UFC history to regain the championship after losing it. He enters the fight with a 30-6 record, including 12 submission wins.

Beyond the flyweight title fight, UFC 331 features a loaded main card. Arman Tsarukyan faces dangerous Brazilian striker Mauricio Ruffy in a five-round lightweight co-main event with major title implications.

Tsarukyan brings a 23-3 professional record, with nine wins by knockout and six by submission. He has won his last five fights, including victories over Dan Hooker and Michael Chandler.

Mauricio Ruffy is 14-2, with an extraordinary 13 of his 14 victories coming by knockout. The Brazilian is on a

two-fight winning streak, having stopped Rafael Fiziev and Michael Chandler.

Former Bellator two-division champion Patricio Pitbull meets Korean veteran Doo Ho Choi, while Renato Moicano takes on former title challenger Brian Ortega in a high-level lightweight clash. At light heavyweight, Alonzo Menifield faces rising Polish prospect Iwo Baraniewski.

End of an era

Katie Taylor (**pic, below**) has retired from boxing after ending her career with another world title victory, defeating Flora Pili by unanimous decision at Croke Park in Dublin.

Taylor, 40, leaves the sport as one of its most successful fighters. She began boxing as a teenager and went on to win five World



Did you know?

Taylor was a footballer before she made her name in boxing. She made her senior debut for the Republic of Ireland in 2006, going on to receive 11 caps and score twice before the end of her international career in 2009. She also played as a midfielder at club level, balancing football alongside boxing before eventually choosing to focus on the sport that would make her a global star.

Championship gold medals and an Olympic gold at the 2012 London Games.

She turned professional in 2016 and became a world champion within a year. In 2019, Taylor became the undisputed lightweight champion after defeating Delfine Persoon. She later moved up to super-lightweight and became undisputed champion there as well. Taylor's rivalry with Amanda Serrano became one of the defining storylines of women's boxing.

Their first fight at Madison Square Garden in 2022 was the first women's bout to headline the venue, with Taylor winning by split decision. The pair eventually fought three times.

Taylor's final fight came against Flora Pili at a packed Croke Park.

She controlled the contest to secure a unanimous decision victory, with two judges scoring it 100-90 and the third 98-91.

Taylor finishes her professional career with a 26-1 record as a three-time undisputed champion, retiring at the top of the sport.

